

Page Experience: Mobile & Core Web Vitals

Mobile-first indexing, LCP, INP, CLS and site speed

Mobile-first indexing

- Same content on mobile and desktop.
- Readable text without zooming; tap targets well spaced.
- Test on a real mid-range phone, not only a fast laptop.

Field data vs lab data

- Field data: real users, 28-day window.
- Lab data: a single simulated run.
- Fix with lab tools, confirm with field data.

Fixing layout shift

- Always set width/height on images and iframes.
- Reserve space for ads and embeds.
- Use font-display and preloading for web fonts.

The three Core Web Vitals

- $LCP \leq 2.5$ seconds.
- $INP \leq 200$ milliseconds.
- $CLS \leq 0.1$.

Fixing slow LCP and poor INP

- Preload and compress the LCP image.
- Cache pages and use a CDN.
- Break up long JavaScript tasks and trim third-party scripts.

Core Web Vitals thresholds (75th percentile of visits)

Metric	Measures	Good	Poor
LCP	Loading	≤ 2.5 s	> 4.0 s
INP	Responsiveness	≤ 200 ms	> 500 ms
CLS	Visual stability	≤ 0.1	> 0.25

Common problems and fixes

Symptom	Likely cause	Fix
Hero image appears late	Huge uncompressed JPEG, lazy-loaded	Compress to WebP, preload, remove lazy-load
Menu reacts slowly to taps	Long JavaScript tasks	Split tasks, defer non-critical scripts
Text jumps while reading	Ad or image without reserved space	Set dimensions, reserve ad slots

Remember

- Google indexes the mobile version of your site.
- Know the thresholds: LCP 2.5 s, INP 200 ms, CLS 0.1.
- Debug with lab tools; judge success by field data.

Watch: Monitor live Core Web Vitals in Chrome DevTools — Chrome for Developers — <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=M5oe010pYbA>